

Overview of the B2 First for Schools Reading and Use of English Paper

Aims of the lesson	To familiarise the students with the content of the First for Schools Reading and Use of English paper (Paper 1)
Time needed	35 minutes
Materials required	▪ Sample Reading and Use of English Paper (one copy for each 2–3 students) ▪ Classroom Handout 1 (one per student) ▪ Answer sheets (one copy for each small group of students) ▪ http://www.cambridgeenglish.org/exams-and-qualifications/first-for-schools/exam-update-for-2015/

Procedure

1. Before the class, stick up a copy of different tasks from the Sample Reading and Use of English Paper around the walls of the classroom. Samples can be found in the B2 First for Schools handbook.
2. Introduce the testing focus of the Reading and Use of English paper by asking students to call out if the following language areas come into knowledge of grammar or of vocabulary.
 - verb tenses
 - phrasal verbs
 - collocation (words which go together)
 - set phrases (e.g. See you later!)
 - suffixes
 - prepositions
 - auxiliaries
 - linkers

Do this quickly, just to get students thinking about language systems. You could point out that some areas can fall under both grammar and vocabulary. Indeed many teachers and students see grammar – vocabulary as a continuum rather than an either/or choice so it is perfectly fine for there to be some ambiguity.

Timing: 5 mins

Answers

verb tenses (<i>grammar</i>)	suffixes <i>vocabulary (and grammar)</i> (different suffixes change the word class of a word)
phrasal verbs (<i>vocabulary and grammar - as well as meaning, learners need to know if it is transitive/intransitive and if the particle affects any subsequent verb</i>);	prepositions (<i>grammar</i>)
collocation (words which go together) (<i>vocabulary and grammar - words which go together - in the case of verb + preposition, for example</i>);	auxiliaries (<i>grammar</i>)
set phrases (e.g. See you later!) <i>vocabulary</i>	linkers (<i>vocabulary and grammar</i>)

3. Explain to students that the Reading and Use of English paper in B2 First for Schools tests their knowledge of these areas, and they are going to find out about it now. They aren't going to do the tasks. Instead, they will answer some questions about the paper to find out what they have to do.

Timing: 2 mins

4. Give out **Classroom handout 1**, and say that if any students already know (or think they know) some of the answers, they can start to fill in the worksheet in pairs (or groups of 3).

Timing: 5 mins

5. Ask the students to go and look at the different tasks on the walls, and fill in as much missing information on their handout as possible in five minutes. Be strict about the timing. You could add a competitive element (who can get the most correct answers).

Timing: 5 mins

6. Students count how many answers they've got. The student with the most answers reads theirs out. Encourage other students to correct any mistakes and to complete their own worksheets. Collect any missing answers from other students until the worksheet is complete (see **Answers to Classroom handout 1**).

Timing: 5 mins

7. Invite students to ask any other questions they may have about the Reading and Use of English paper. Discuss the following questions with students:

Which part do you think you'll find easiest? Which part do you think will be the most difficult?

What aspect(s) do you think you'll need to work on most? Vocabulary, grammar, spelling, reading skills, etc.

Refer to the B2 First for Schools Handbook if necessary.

Timing: 7 mins

An alternative here if the students have had some practice would be to have them rank the activities in terms of difficulty and compare with a partner.

8. Give out the answer sheets to each small group, so they can see where they will write their answers. Point out that they can write their answers on the question paper, but they must transfer their answers onto the answer sheet within the 1 hour 15 minutes. They have to shade in a small box in pencil or write a word or words in capital letters (they must not use pen to complete the answer sheet).

Classroom Handout 1

Whole paper	
How long is the paper?	_____
How many parts are there?	_____ parts
Candidates must write the answers in pencil on an answer sheet.	True/False
ALL _____ MUST BE CORRECT.	
Part 1 MULTIPLE-CHOICE CLOZE	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	_____ questions
How many possible answers are there for each question?	_____ options
What is being tested in this task? Grammar or Vocab?	emphasis on _____ over _____
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each
Part 2 OPEN CLOZE	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	_____ questions
What is being tested in this task? Grammar or Vocab?	focus on _____ over _____
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each
Part 3 WORD FORMATION	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	_____ questions
What is being tested in this task?	emphasis on _____
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each

Part 4 KEY WORD TRANSFORMATIONS	
What do you have to do?	complete a gapped response using a key word
How many questions are there?	_____ questions
How many words do you write for each answer?	use 2 - _____ words to complete the gap (including the key word)
What is being tested in this task?	emphasis on grammar and vocabulary
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	up to 2 marks each
Part 5 MULTIPLE CHOICE	
What do you have to do?	read a text and answer 4-option multiple choice questions about it
How many questions are there?	_____
What is being tested in this task?	understanding the main idea and detail in the text, opinion and attitude, referencing and vocabulary _____
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	
Part 6 GAPPED TEXT	
What do you have to do?	decide which _____ fits each gap in a text
How many questions are there?	_____
What is being tested in this task?	the ability to follow the development of a long text, understanding of coherence and cohesion
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	_____
Part 7 MULTIPLE MATCHING	
What do you have to do?	match the correct _____ to each question
How many questions are there?	10
What is being tested in this task?	locating specific information and detail
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	_____

Answers

Whole paper	
How long is the paper?	1 hour 15 minutes
How many parts are there?	7 parts
Candidates must write the answers on an answer sheet in pencil.	True
ALL SPELLING MUST BE CORRECT	
Part 1 MULTIPLE-CHOICE CLOZE	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	8 questions
How many possible answers are there for each question?	4 options
What is being tested in this task?	emphasis on vocabulary and grammar
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each
Part 2 OPEN CLOZE	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	8 questions
What is being tested in this task?	focus on grammar and vocabulary
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each
Part 3 WORD FORMATION	
What do you have to do?	fill in the gaps in a text
How many questions are there?	8 questions
What is being tested in this task?	emphasis on vocabulary
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1 mark each
Part 4 KEY WORD TRANSFORMATIONS	
What do you have to do?	complete a gapped response using a key word
How many questions are there?	6 questions
How many words do you write for each answer?	use 2-5 words to complete the gap (including the key word)
What is being tested in this task?	emphasis on grammar and vocabulary
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	up to 2 marks each

Part 5 MULTIPLE CHOICE	
What do you have to do?	read a text and answer 4-option multiple choice questions about it
How many questions are there?	6
What is being tested in this task?	understanding the main idea and detail in the text, opinion and attitude, referencing and vocabulary
Part 6 GAPPED TEXT	
What do you have to do?	decide which sentence fits each gap in a text
How many questions are there?	6
What is being tested in this task?	the ability to follow the development of a long text, understanding of coherence and cohesion
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	2
Part 7 MULTIPLE MATCHING	
What do you have to do?	match the correct text to each question
How many questions are there?	10
What is being tested in this task?	locating specific information and detail
How many marks do you get for each correct answer?	1